

London Stock Exchange Group plc

Recommendation **BUY** ★ ★ ★ ★ ★

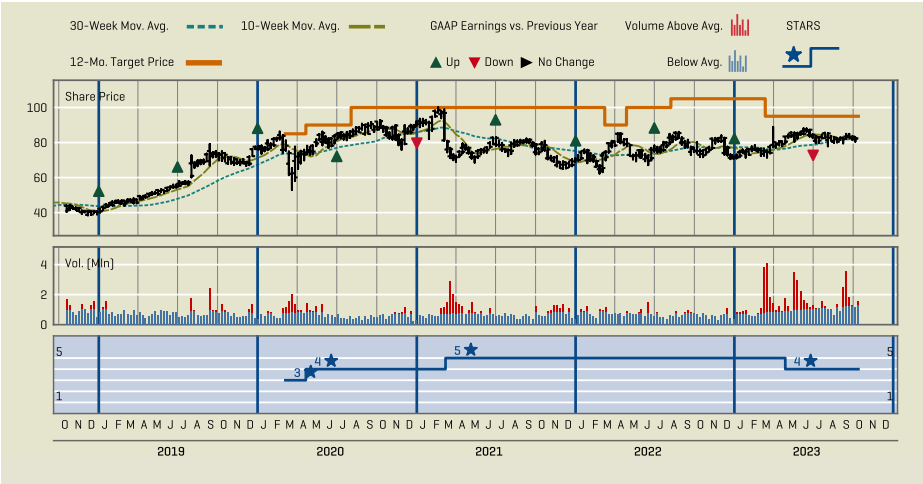
Price GBP 82.12 [as of market close Oct 13, 2023] **12-Mo. Target Price** GBP 95.00 **Report Currency** GBP **Investment Style** Large-Cap Growth

Equity Analyst Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA

GICS Sector Financials **Sub-Industry** Financial Exchanges and Data **Summary** London Stock Exchange Group is a global financial markets infrastructure provider.

Key Stock Statistics [Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence (SPGMI), Company Reports]							
52-Wk Range	GBP 88.94 - 70.52	Oper.EPS2023E	GBP 3.50	Market Capitalization[B]	GBP 44.44	Beta	0.35
Trailing 12-Month EPS	GBP 3.11	Oper.EPS2024E	GBP 3.90	Yield [%]	1.35	3-yr Proj. EPS CAGR[%]	19
Trailing 12-Month P/E	26.41	P/E on Oper.EPS2023E	23.46	Dividend Rate/Share	GBP 1.11	SPGMI's Quality Ranking	B
GBP 10K Invested 5 Yrs Ago	21,220.0	Common Shares Outstg.[M]	552.00	Trailing 12-Month Dividend	GBP 1.11	Institutional Ownership [%]	60.0

Price Performance



Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied upon as such.
Analysis prepared by **Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA** on Aug 14, 2023 01:11 AM ET, when the stock traded at **GBP 82.70**.

Highlights

- ▶ London Stock Exchange's (LSE) H1 2023 adjusted EBITDA was up 4% Y/Y to GBP1.87 bln and its revenue rose 12% Y/Y to GBP3.99 bln. The result was within expectation, with its adjusted EBITDA and revenue making up 50% and 49% of consensus full year 2023 estimates. Adjusted EBITDA margin contracted to 46.9% (50.4%) due to non-cash FX-related balance sheet adjustment, impact of recent acquisitions, and product development costs. That said, LSE is still confident of hitting its full year EBITDA margin of ~48%.
- ▶ We forecast high-single-digit CAGR in revenue for LSE over the next two years, driven by key long-term drivers such as growth of passive funds and the rising demand for data and digitalization. Near-term heightened market volatility will also benefit LSE's trading-related revenues, in our view. We expect a mid-single-digit rise in underlying operating expenses over the next two years, mainly driven by spending to improve operational resilience, expenditure on efficiency-related projects, and development of new products and services to drive future growth.
- ▶ We forecast EPS of GBP3.50 for 2023 and GBP3.90 for 2024.

Investment Rationale/Risk

- ▶ Our call is 4-STARS [Buy]. We believe LSE is strongly positioned to benefit from growing industry trends such as increasing use of data, the global nature of trading, and growth in passive investment strategies. The Refinitiv acquisition has improved LSE's revenue profile, in our view, with LSE now relying less on uneven income from trading, diversifying into data distribution. We see momentum in LSE's transformation as it upgraded 2025 run rate revenue synergy target to GBP350-400 mln vs. GBP225 mln and expects to deliver the 2025 cost synergy target of GBP400 mln two years ahead of plan. We are positive about its partnership with Microsoft, which we think will allow LSE to capture market share, add further scalability and close down pricing gap with premium-priced competitors.
- ▶ Key downside risks include a letdown in delivery targeted synergies, unsuccessful integration of acquired companies, and unfavorable regulatory changes.
- ▶ We keep our 12-month target price for LSE at GBP95, reflecting 2023 P/E of 27x, largely in line with its 5-year average forward P/E of 28.2x. We think this fairly balances LSE's changing business mix post-Refinitiv acquisition with current macro-economic headwinds.

Analyst's Risk Assessment

LOW **MEDIUM** **HIGH**

Our risk assessment reflects LSEG's strong balance sheet and cash generation ability. These are offset by its exposure to volatile capital markets.

Revenue/Earnings Data

Revenue (Million GBP)			
	1H	2H	Year
2024	--	--	E 8,700
2023	4,179	--	E 8,250
2022	3,735	4,008	7,743
2021	3,356	3,384	6,535
2020	1,235	795	2,030
2019	1,140	2,256	2,314

Earnings Per Share (GBP)			
	1H	2H	Year
2024	--	--	E 3.90
2023	1.61	--	E 3.50
2022	1.66	1.50	3.16
2021	1.46	4.32	5.78
2020	0.64	0.97	2.07
2019	0.99	1.01	2.00

Fiscal Year ended Dec 31. EPS Estimates based on CFRA's Operating Earnings; historical earnings are adjusted. In periods where a different currency has been reported, this has been adjusted to match the current quoted currency.

Dividend Data

Amount [GBP]	Date Decl.	Ex-Div. Date	Stk. of Record	Payment Date
0.3570	Aug 03	Aug 17	Aug 18	Sep 20 '23
0.7530	Mar 02	Apr 20	Apr 21	May 24 '23
0.3170	Aug 05	Aug 18	Apr 19	Sep 20 '22
0.7000	Mar 03	Apr 28	Apr 29	May 25 '22
0.2500	Aug 06	Aug 19	Aug 20	Sep 21 '21
0.5170	Mar 05	Apr 29	Apr 30	May 26 '21

Dividends have been paid since 2001 . Source: Company reports
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied as such.
Forecasts are not a reliable indicator of future performance.
Dividends paid in currencies other than the Trading currency have been accordingly converted for display purposes.

London Stock Exchange Group plc

Business Summary May 02, 2023

COMPANY PROFILE: London Stock Exchange Group [LSE] is a diversified global financial markets infrastructure and data business. It is the operator of the London Stock Exchange, one of the world’s older stock exchanges and can trace its history back more than 300 years. The current LSE was created in October 2007 when London Stock Exchange merged with Milan Stock Exchange, Borsa Italiana. In January 2021, LSE completed the acquisition of Refinitiv to create a leading global financial markets infrastructure and data provider. LSE’s revenue by geography as of 2022: EMEA [45%]; Americas [40%]; APAC [15%].

BUSINESS SEGMENTS: 1) Data & Analytics [68% of 2022 revenue]. This segment became prominent after LSE’s acquisition of Refinitiv, providing high-performance solutions, from trading and market surveillance to wealth solutions and more. FTSE Russell, which is also under this segment, is a leading global provider of financial indexing, benchmarking, and analytic services with more than USD16 trillion benchmarked to its indices.

2) Capital Markets [19% of revenue]. LSE offers customers extensive access to capital markets and liquidity across multiple asset classes. It operates a broad range of international equity, fixed income, exchange-traded funds/exchange-traded products and foreign exchange markets. LSE is home to several capital formation and execution venues: London Stock Exchange, AIM, Turquoise, CurveGlobal, FXall, and Tradeweb [through a majority ownership interest]. This segment also includes its Technology Services division.

3) Post-Trade [13% of revenue]. LSE supports its customers’ clearing and reporting obligations, providing risk, balance sheet, and financial resource management solutions, while working with its other divisions to extend this support across the value chain. A leading global clearing house with a strong presence across multiple asset classes, LSE helps financial institutions all over the world use their capital efficiently and manage counterparty risk. LSE works closely with sell-side clearing members and buy-side clients in conjunction with trading venues globally.

CORPORATE STRATEGY: LSE’s long-term strategy builds on its strengths as a Group. LSE is investing in solutions and services that can adapt and scale in evolving financial markets. Its strategy is to be:

[1] Globally essential. LSE aims to be a global player that provides critical infrastructure and insight to customers, required for the efficient running of financial markets. This is important because the demand and presence of its customers are increasingly borderless and complex. LSE’s global coverage and comprehensive offering underpins customers’ critical workflows and supports the allocation of capital across international financial markets;

[2] Multi-asset class. LSE aims to be a leader across traditional and emerging asset classes, in both public and private markets. It will provide liquidity and asset-class agnostic insight for its customers across the world. This is important because trading and investment strategies are increasingly incorporating a greater mix of asset classes which in turn broaden the data and information required to manage portfolios and execute transactions; and

[3] Seamlessly connected. LSE provides access to open platforms and venues that integrate seamlessly across workflows that matter, from pre-trade decision making, to trade execution and clearing. By providing integrated solutions across the value chain, LSE is building deeper customer relationships and working in partnership to help customers address this complexity in a way that few other providers are able to. This is expected to lead to new product innovation and growth opportunities.

CORPORATE DEVELOPMENT: LSE completed the acquisition of Refinitiv in January 2021 for USD27 billion. Refinitiv is one of the world’s largest providers of financial markets data and infrastructure. With the acquisition, LSE completed a multiyear effort to become less dependent on transaction-based revenue and has picked up a series of financial data assets that will further reduce its reliance on its U.K. and European business.

At the end of 2022, LSE announced a new strategic partnership with Microsoft to develop LSE’s data infrastructure using the Microsoft Cloud and to jointly develop new products and services for data and analytics. It believes that the deal will significantly accelerate its strategy towards becoming the world’s leading financial markets infrastructure, data, and analytics provider.

FINANCIAL TRENDS: In 2022, total income excluding recoveries grew by 6% to GBP7.4 billion, reflecting strong revenue growth across all divisions. Adjusted operating expenses before depreciation, amortization, and impairment grew by 4% to GBP3.1 billion. Adjusted EBITDA increased by 6% to GBP3.6 billion, with its margin flat year-over-year at 47.8%. The Board has proposed a final dividend of GBp75.3 per share, which, together with the interim dividend of GBp31.7 per share already paid in September 2022, results in a 13% increase in dividend payment as compared to 2021 dividend.

Corporate information

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Interim Group Head of Data Independent Chairman and Analytics, Group CEO & Executive Director D. A. Robert
Executive Director D. A. Schwimmer
COO & Head of Integration D. Shalders

Group General Counsel & Head of Compliance
C. Johnson

Group CFO & Director
A. M. Manz

Board Members
A. M. Manz K. T. DeRose
A. V. Vaswani M. J. Brand
C. M. Hogg S. D. Guthrie
D. A. Robert T. Gebreyes
D. A. Schwimmer V. Rahmani
D. Blakemore W. M. Vereker

Domicile United Kingdom
Auditor Ernst & Young LLP

Founded
1698

Employees
24,296

Stockholders
N/A

London Stock Exchange Group plc

Quantitative Evaluations							Expanded Ratio Analysis					
Fair Value Rank	NR	1	2	3	4	5		2022	2021	2020	2019	
		LOWEST			HIGHEST			Price/Sales	5.16	5.74	15.71	11.82
		Based on CFRA's proprietary quantitative model, stocks are ranked from most overvalued [1] to most undervalued [5].										
Fair Value Calculation	N/A											
Volatility	NA	LOW		AVERAGE		HIGH						
Technical Evaluation	BULLISH	Since September, 2023, the technical indicators for LSEG LN have been BULLISH"										
Insider Activity		UNFAVORABLE		NEUTRAL		FAVORABLE						
Key Growth Rates and Averages												
Past Growth Rate [%]								1 Year	3 Years	5 Years		
Net Income								NM	46.16	20.85		
Sales								18.48	49.57	31.69		
Ratio Analysis (Annual Avg.)												
Net Margin [%]								16.82	28.48	25.19		
% LT Debt to Capitalization								18.73	21.00	23.45		
Return on Equity [%]								3.65	5.52	8.76		

Company Financials Fiscal year ending Dec 31										
Per Share Data [GBP]	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015	2014	2013
Tangible Book Value	-16.37	-14.52	-1.75	-2.77	-3.87	-3.94	-2.91	-2.76	-4.08	-1.92
Free Cash Flow	3.18	3.66	2.22	1.84	1.52	1.36	0.27	0.91	0.96	1.10
Earnings	1.41	0.85	0.83	1.18	1.36	1.50	0.62	0.74	0.36	0.79
Earnings [Normalized]	3.16	2.87	2.07	2.00	1.71	1.45	1.22	1.28	1.04	1.05
Dividends	1.07	0.95	0.75	0.70	0.60	0.52	0.43	0.36	0.31	0.30
Payout Ratio [%]	43.55	13.61	61.05	53.00	39.38	31.49	85.53	35.18	41.08	35.67
Prices: High	86.12	100.10	92.88	79.22	48.14	40.69	29.60	27.86	20.53	14.31
Prices: Low	62.30	65.02	53.00	40.05	36.12	28.77	20.83	21.66	12.38	9.14
P/E Ratio: High	27.20	34.90	44.80	39.60	28.20	28.00	24.20	21.80	9.90	13.60
P/E Ratio: Low	19.70	22.70	25.60	20.00	21.10	19.80	17.00	17.00	6.00	8.70
Income Statement Analysis [Million GBP]										
Revenue	7,743	6,535	2,030	2,314	2,135	1,955	1,657	1,419	1,210	853.00
Operating Income	1,707	1,454	768.00	922.00	787.00	667.00	541.00	436.00	394.00	339.00
Depreciation + Amortization	1,843	1,503	145.00	224.00	161.00	154.00	147.00	170.00	107.00	77.00
Interest Expense	181.00	175.00	61.00	77.00	72.00	63.00	65.00	66.00	49.00	48.00
Pretax Income	1,241	894.00	492.00	651.00	685.00	564.00	364.00	336.00	267.00	299.00
Effective Tax Rate	21.10	33.80	28.00	28.60	19.30	-3.90	27.70	14.30	30.40	27.90
Net Income	1,302	3,129	421.00	417.00	480.00	505.00	152.00	328.00	182.00	217.00
Net Income [Normalized]	767.90	678.40	372.10	473.20	372.60	317.80	256.20	201.50	190.60	183.90
Balance Sheet and Other Financial Data [Million GBP]										
Cash	3,435	2,665	1,785	1,493	1,510	1,381	1,225	924.00	919.00	446.00
Current Assets	797,791	752,897	844,069	798,514	837,833	737,018	560,375	459,264	453,202	146,760
Total Assets	835,156	787,109	849,141	803,651	842,846	741,980	564,796	463,251	507,857	148,926
Current Liabilities	796,469	750,767	842,970	797,538	836,853	736,172	559,760	458,590	453,037	146,363
Long Term Debt	6,943	7,699	1,357	1,612	1,659	1,460	566.00	679.00	936.00	800.00
Total Capital	37,070	33,940	6,282	6,109	5,953	5,741	4,799	4,805	3,234	2,399
Capital Expenditures	193.00	90.00	19.00	41.00	50.00	47.00	34.00	30.00	24.00	18.00
Cash from Operations	2,737	2,602	972.00	837.00	722.00	659.00	241.00	434.00	325.00	342.00
Current Ratio	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
% Long Term Debt of Capitalization	18.70	22.70	21.60	26.40	27.90	25.40	11.80	14.10	29.00	33.30
% Net Income of Revenue	16.80	47.90	20.70	18.00	22.50	25.80	9.20	23.10	15.30	25.40
% Return on Assets	0.13	0.11	0.06	0.07	0.06	0.06	0.07	0.06	0.07	0.17
% Return on Equity	3.60	4.00	8.90	12.40	14.80	15.90	7.70	9.40	11.00	14.10

Source: S&P Global Market Intelligence. Data may be preliminary or restated; before results of discontinued operations/special items. Per share data adjusted for stock dividends; EPS diluted. E-Estimated. NA-Not Available. NM-Not Meaningful. NR-Not Ranked. UR-Under Review.

London Stock Exchange Group plc**Industry Outlook**

We are neutral on EMEA financials. We think the sector in general will benefit from the higher interest rate environment in Europe. This is balanced by growing concerns about the economy, including slower growth and persistent inflation. The recent banking turmoil has also increased the scrutiny on the sector.

For the bank sub-industry, we have a neutral view. We expect the European banks under our coverage will continue to benefit from the higher interest rate environment as inflation rate is still well above the European Central Bank's target of 2%. As banks continue to pass more of the higher rate to their customers, we expect to see expanding net interest margin and net interest income. However, we expect loan loss provision to increase as consumers and businesses will start to feel the negative impact from the tough economic situation. Asset quality will also be tested and we will also start to see increases in non-performing loans. We think that the risk of a liquidity-related failure, such as the one that caused the collapse of Silicon Valley Bank (SVB) in the U.S., for European banks is well-contained, given the high liquidity coverage ratios (LCRs) of European banks as compared to their U.S. counterparts. Investors can take comfort in European banks' capital levels that have greatly improved since the 2008 global financial crisis.

For the insurance sub-industry, we are neutral on its outlook. We see rising interest rate environment continues to benefit insurance companies, particularly life insurers, as it allows them to generate higher reinvestment yields and ease their obligation to meet government-mandated returns on written policies. Also, the heightened market volatility is likely to support demand for pension risk transfer, in our view, as clients seek stability by de-risking their pension obligations. However, we are cautious about slowing growth in gross written premium and higher surrenders for life policies amid an anticipated subdued economic growth in Europe. For P&C insurers, the rise in claim cost inflation may normalize slightly in 2023 but remains

challenging to navigate, in our opinion, as insurers' attempt to eke out margin improvement by focusing on underwriting quality may come with the expense of weaker premium growth. Conversely, we believe the outlook for the reinsurers under our coverage is relatively more positive.

We are also neutral on the asset management sub-industry, where we expect asset under management (AUM) growth to slow down amid macro uncertainties. Two of the main positive factors for AUM growth are new products and new geographic markets. Investments that have been made to target new sources of AUM in the retail space more efficiently and to attract new mandates (especially from institutional investors) by offering extended quantitative and big data solutions are also potential drivers for AUM growth, in our view. Despite relatively strong expectations for top-line growth, fee income is expected to grow more slowly, which implies further falls in fee margin (as a percentage of AUM).

Year-to-date through July 20, 2023, the S&P Europe 350 Financials Index was up 8.8%, largely mirroring the performance of the broader market, represented by the S&P Europe 350 Index, which recorded a gain of 8.9% during the same period.

/ Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA

Sub-Industry: Financial Exchanges and Data Peer Group*: Financial Exchanges and Data

Peer Group	Stock Symbol	Exchange	Currency	Recent Stock Price	Stk. Mkt. Cap. (M)	30-Day Price Chg. (%)	1-Year Price Chg. (%)	P/E Ratio	Fair Value Calc.	Yield (%)	Return on Equity (%)	LTD to Cap (%)
London Stock Exchange Group	LSEG LN	LSE	GBP	82.12	44,192.0	-0.4	12.5	26.0	N/A	1.4	3.2	17.3
CME Group Inc	CME	NasdaqGS	USD	219.38	78,922.0	5.8	25.8	25.0	N/A	2.0	10.7	10.8
Deutsche Boerse	DB1 GR	XTRA	EUR	158.80	29,307.0	-2.8	-2.4	18.0	N/A	2.3	19.8	30.3
Euronext	ENX	N/A	N/A	68.25	7,230.0	5.9	10.6	19.0	N/A	3.3	10.6	43.0
Hong Kong Exchanges & Clearing	388 HK	SEHK	HKD	292.40	369,917.0	-2.9	13.2	32.0	N/A	2.8	22.9	0.1
Intercontinental Exchange	ICE	NYSE	USD	110.43	61,874.0	-5.4	19.4	20.0	N/A	1.5	7.5	42.9
Nasdaq Stock Market	NDAQ	NasdaqGS	USD	49.37	24,256.0	-3.4	-15.7	18.0	N/A	1.8	18.2	58.8

*For Peer Groups with more than 10 companies or stocks, selection of issues is based on market capitalization.

NA-Not Available; NM-Not Meaningful.

Note: Peers are selected based on Global Industry Classification Standards and market capitalization. The peer group list includes companies with similar characteristics, but may not include all the companies within the same industry and/or that engage in the same line of business.

London Stock Exchange Group plc

Analyst Research Notes and other Company News

August 04, 2023

03:00 AM ET... CFRA Reiterates Buy Opinion on Shares of London Stock Exchange [LSEG LN 81.88****]:

We keep our 12-month target price for LSE at GBP95, reflecting a 2023 P/E of 27x, largely in line with its 5-year average forward P/E of 28.2x. We think this fairly balances LSE's changing business mix post-Refinitiv acquisition with current macroeconomic headwinds. LSE's H1 2023 adjusted EBITDA was up 4% Y/Y to GBP1.87 bln and its revenue up 12% Y/Y to GBP3.99 bln. The result was within expectation, with its adjusted EBITDA and revenue making up 50% and 49% of consensus full-year 2023 estimates. Adjusted EBITDA margin contracted to 46.9% [50.4%] due to non-cash FX-related balance sheet adjustment, impact of recent acquisitions, and product development costs. That said, LSE is still confident of hitting its full-year EBITDA margin of ~48%. We remain positive on LSE's progress in becoming the leading global financial markets infrastructure and data provider. This will be helped by the U.K. government's series of reforms to make London's capital market more competitive, in our view. / Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA

April 28, 2023

02:57 AM ET... CFRA Lowers Opinion on Shares of London Stock Exchange to Buy from Strong Buy [LSEG LN 80.84****]:

We keep our 12-month target price for LSE at GBP95, reflecting 2024 P/E of 24x, largely in line with peer average forward P/E of 22x. We keep our EPS forecasts unchanged. LSE reported 7.5% Y/Y growth in Q1 2023 total income [ex. recoveries], at the higher end of its full year guidance of 6-8%. Data & Analytics' revenues were up 7.1% due to improving sales and retention, as well as higher annual price increases. Capital Markets' revenues rose 2.5%, driven mainly by Tradeweb. Post Trade revenues increased 16.8% on the back of heightened market volatility. We remain positive on LSE's 2023 prospects, with the company confirming its full-year targets. Partnerships and acquisitions will also help LSE's long-term ambition to become the leading global financial markets infrastructure and data provider, in our view. However, we believe macro headwinds, including high inflation, have increased the challenges for LSE in achieving its ambitions, notably on costs. Hence, we lower our call a notch to Buy. / Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA

March 13, 2023

01:51 AM ET... CFRA Keeps Strong Buy Opinion on Shares of London Stock Exchange Group [LSEG LN 73.62****]:

We adjust our 12-month target price for LSE to GBP95 (from GBP105), reflecting 2024 P/E of 24.4x, largely in line with peer average forward P/E of 24.6x. We trim our 2023 EPS to GBP3.50 [from GBP3.60] and initiate 2024 EPS of GBP3.90. LSE's 2022 normalized EPS of GBP3.18 was in line with consensus. Adjusted EBITDA up 19.6% [+6.0% at constant currency] to GBP3.55 bln with EBITDA margin stable at 47.8%. The result reflects solid revenue growth [+6.6%] with positive contributions from all three divisions – Data & Analytics +5.3%, Capital Markets +9.8%, and Post Trade +7.5%, coupled with disciplined cost management. We see momentum in LSE's transformation as it upgraded 2025 run rate revenue synergy target to GBP350-400 mln vs. GBP225 mln and expects to deliver the 2025 cost synergy target of GBP400 mln two years ahead of plan. We are positive on its partnership with Microsoft, which we think will allow LSE to capture market share and close down pricing gap with premium-priced competitors. / Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA

November 21, 2022

03:07 AM ET... CFRA Reiterates Strong Buy Opinion on Shares of London Stock Exchange [LSEG LN 81.22****]:

We keep our 12-month target price for LSE at GBP105, reflecting 2023 P/E of 29.2x, justified in our view by the change in business mix towards high quality recurring revenue post-Refinitiv acquisition. In its brief trading update in October, LSE registered a revenue of GBP1.98 bln in Q3 2022, up 15% Y/Y, in line with company-compiled consensus estimate. The performance reflects strong double-digit growth in all segments, particularly Capital Markets, which saw 19% growth on the back of strong FX and derivatives revenues. With Data & Analytics also reporting a solid 15% revenue growth, we think this continues to highlight LSE's high quality recurring revenues. Gross profit increased 13% Y/Y to GBP1.69 bln, also in line with consensus. Near-term heightened market volatility will continue to benefit LSE's trading-related revenues, in our view. We think this is a solid result that will support delivery of its 2022 targets and synergies related to recent acquisitions. / Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA

August 08, 2022

01:02 AM ET... CFRA Reiterates Strong Buy Opinion on Shares of London Stock Exchange [LSEG LN 82.78****]:

We raise our 12-month target price for London Stock Exchange [LSE] to GBP105 [from GBP100], reflecting 2022 P/E of 31.8x, a premium to its 10-year forward P/E of 22.6x, justified in our view by the change in business mix towards high quality recurring revenue post-Refinitiv acquisition. We keep our above-consensus EPS forecasts following LSE's H1 2022 result, where its adjusted net profit up 22% Y/Y to GBP1.06 bln, with normalized EPS of GBP1.66 beating S&P Capital IQ consensus estimate of GBP1.50. Underlying revenues up 10% with strong growth across all divisions as LSE benefited from elevated market volatility and increase demand for derivatives. Its adjusted EBITDA margin improved to 48.8% vs. 47.2% as at end of 2021. We remain positive on LSE's progress in integrating the Refinitiv business and meeting its 2022 targets. The 27% higher interim dividend of GBP31.7 per share and GBP750 mln share buyback signify the company is on track with the execution of its strategy, in our opinion. / Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA

April 28, 2022

12:43 AM ET... CFRA Reiterates Strong Buy Opinion on Shares of London Stock Exchange [LSEG LN 79.60****]:

We raise our 12-month target price for London Stock Exchange [LSE] to GBP100 [from GBP90], reflecting a 2022 P/E of 30.3x, above peer average forward P/E of 25.2x, justified in our view by its high quality recurring revenue. LSE's Q1 2022 revenues were up 7% Y/Y to GBP1.75 billion, in line with S&P Capital IQ consensus estimate. All segments contributed positively, notably Capital Markets, where revenues were up 13%, benefiting from higher market volatility that drove trading volume. LSE's biggest segment, Data & Analytics, also posted solid revenue growth of 7%, mainly driven by higher subscription and asset-based revenues, and higher demand for data. We believe LSE will continue to benefit from higher market volatility throughout 2022. We remain positive on LSE's progress in integrating the Refinitiv business and meeting its 2022 targets. Recent acquisitions and divestments will also help to improve LSE's profitability and growth profile, in our view. / Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA

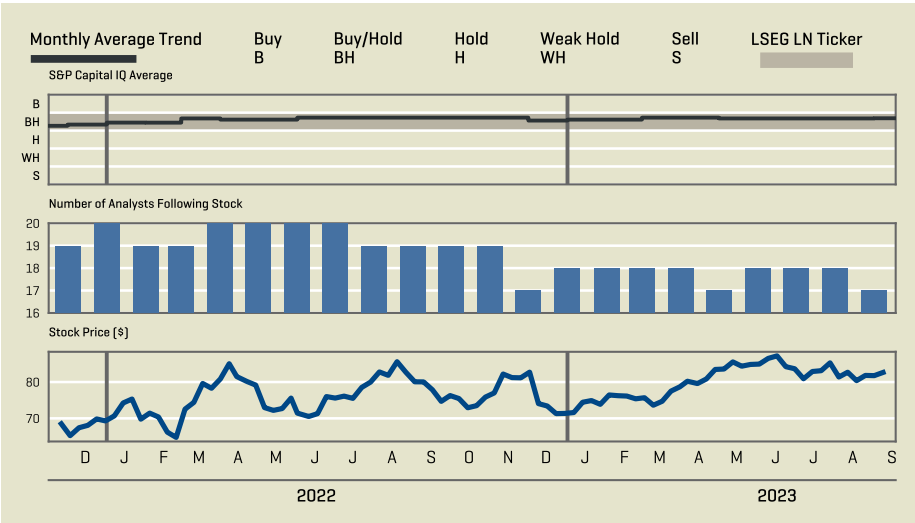
March 08, 2022

11:08 PM ET... CFRA Keeps Strong Buy Opinion on Shares of London Stock Exchange Group plc [LSEG LN 69.82****]:

We adjust our 12-month target price for London Stock Exchange [LSE] to GBP90 [GBP100], reflecting a 2022 P/E of 27.3x, in line with peer average forward P/E of 28.9x. We cut our 2022 EPS forecast to GBP3.3 [GBP3.4] and introduce 2023 EPS forecast of GBP3.6. LSE posted solid results in 2021, with revenues of GBP6.81 billion, up 6%, and adjusted EBITDA of GBP3.3 billion, up 8%, coming in line with company-compiled consensus estimates. The result reflects strong revenue growth across all business lines – Data & Analytics up 5%, Capital Markets up 13%, and Post-Trade up 2%. Operating expenses rose 4.8%, slightly lower than LSE's guidance of 5%, reflecting impact from Refinitiv acquisitions, investments, and inflation. We expect LSE to continue delivering on its targets for 2022 and see strong execution in the integration of the Refinitiv business. In the near term, increased volatility due to the Russia-Ukraine conflict should boost its trading income, in our view. / Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA

Note: Research notes reflect CFRA's published opinions and analysis on the stock at the time the note was published. The note reflects the views of the equity analyst as of the date and time indicated in the note, and may not reflect CFRA's current view on the company.

Analysts Recommendations



	No. of Recommendations	% of Total	1 Mo. Prior	3 Mos. Prior
Buy	6	35	6	6
Buy/Hold	7	41	7	8
Hold	3	18	3	3
Weak hold	0	0	0	0
Sell	0	0	0	0
No Opinion	1	6	1	1
Total	17	100	17	18

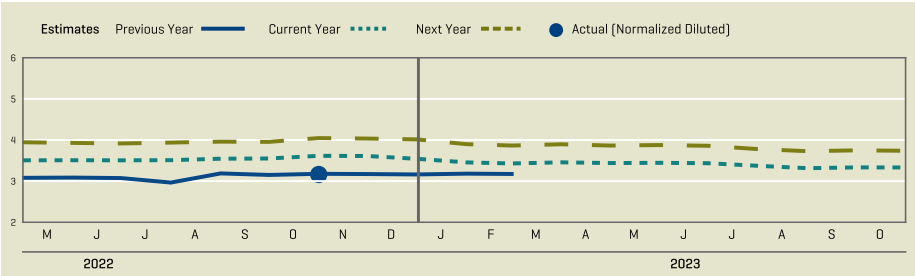
Wall Street Consensus Opinion

Buy/Hold

Wall Street Consensus vs. Performance

For fiscal year 2023, analysts estimate that LSEG LN will earn GBP 3.33. For fiscal year 2024, analysts estimate that LSEG LN's earnings per share will grow by 12.17% to GBP 3.74.

Wall Street Consensus Estimates



Fiscal Year	Avg Est.	High Est.	Low Est.	# of Est.	Est. P/E
2024	3.74	4.16	3.46	16	21.97
2023	3.33	3.76	3.22	16	24.64
2024 vs. 2023	▲ 12%	▲ 11%	▲ 8%	N/A%	▼ -11%

Forecasts are not reliable indicator of future performance.

Note: A company's earnings outlook plays a major part in any investment decision. S&P Global Market Intelligence organizes the earnings estimates of over 2,300 Wall Street analysts, and provides their consensus of earnings over the next two years, as well as how those earnings estimates have changed over time. Note that the information provided in relation to consensus estimates is not intended to predict actual results and should not be taken as a reliable indicator of future performance.

Note: For all tables, graphs and charts in this report that do not cite any reference or source, the source is S&P Global Market Intelligence.

London Stock Exchange Group plc

Glossary

STARS

Since January 1, 1987, CFRA Equity and Fund Research Services, and its predecessor S&P Capital IQ Equity Research has ranked a universe of U.S. common stocks, ADRs [American Depositary Receipts], and ADSs [American Depositary Shares] based on a given equity's potential for future performance. Similarly, we have ranked Asian and European equities since June 30, 2002. Under proprietary STARS [Stock Appreciation Ranking System], equity analysts rank equities according to their individual forecast of an equity's future total return potential versus the expected total return of a relevant benchmark [e.g., a regional index (MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, MSCI AC Europe Index or S&P 500® Index)], based on a 12-month time horizon. STARS was designed to help investors looking to put their investment decisions in perspective. Data used to assist in determining the STARS ranking may be the result of the analyst's own models as well as internal proprietary models resulting from dynamic data inputs.

S&P Global Market Intelligence's Quality Ranking

[also known as **S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings**] - Growth and S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings stability of earnings and dividends are deemed key elements in establishing S&P Global Market Intelligence's earnings and dividend rankings for common stocks, which are designed to capsize the nature of this record in a single symbol. It should be noted, however, that the process also takes into consideration certain adjustments and modifications deemed desirable in establishing such rankings. The final score for each stock is measured against a scoring matrix determined by analysis of the scores of a large and representative sample of stocks. The range of scores in the array of this sample has been aligned with the following ladder of rankings:

A+ Highest	B Below Average
A High	B- Lower
A Above	C Lowest
B+ Average	D In Reorganization
NC Not Ranked	

EPS Estimates

CFRA's earnings per share (EPS) estimates reflect analyst projections of future EPS from continuing operations, and generally exclude various items that are viewed as special, non-recurring, or extraordinary. Also, EPS estimates reflect either forecasts of equity analysts; or, the consensus [average] EPS estimate, which are independently compiled by S&P Global Market Intelligence, a data provider to CFRA. Among the items typically excluded from EPS estimates are asset sale gains; impairment, restructuring or merger-related charges; legal and insurance settlements; in process research and development expenses; gains or losses on the extinguishment of debt; the cumulative effect of accounting changes; and earnings related to operations that have been classified by the company as discontinued. The inclusion of some items, such as stock option expense and recurring types of other charges, may vary, and depend on such factors as industry practice, analyst judgment, and the extent to which some types of data is disclosed by companies.

12-Month Target Price

The equity analyst's projection of the market price a given security will command 12 months hence, based on a combination of intrinsic, relative, and private market valuation metrics, including Fair Value.

Abbreviations Used in Equity Research Reports

CAGR - Compound Annual Growth Rate
CAPEX - Capital Expenditures
CY - Calendar Year
DCF - Discounted Cash Flow
DDM - Dividend Discount Model
EBIT - Earnings Before Interest and Taxes
EBITDA - Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation & Amortization
EPS - Earnings Per Share
EV - Enterprise Value
FCF - Free Cash Flow
FFO - Funds From Operations
FY - Fiscal Year
P/E - Price/Earnings
P/NAV - Price to Net Asset Value
PEG Ratio - P/E-to-Growth Ratio
PV - Present Value
R&D - Research & Development
ROCE - Return on Capital Employed
ROE Return on Equity
ROI - Return on Investment
ROIC - Return on Invested Capital
ROA - Return on Assets
SG&A - Selling, General & Administrative Expenses
SOTP - Sum-of-The-Parts
WACC - Weighted Average Cost of Capital

Dividends on American Depositary Receipts (ADRs) and American Depositary Shares (ADSs) are net of taxes (paid in the country of origin).

Qualitative Risk Assessment

Reflects an equity analyst's view of a given company's operational risk, or the risk of a firm's ability to continue as an ongoing concern. The Qualitative Risk Assessment is a relative ranking to the U.S. STARS universe, and should be reflective of risk factors related to a company's operations, as opposed to risk and volatility measures associated with share prices. For an ETF this reflects on a capitalization-weighted basis, the average qualitative risk assessment assigned to holdings of the fund.

STARS Ranking system and definition:

★★★★★ 5-STARS (Strong Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark, by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares rising in price on an absolute basis.

★★★★★ 4-STARS (Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 3-STARS (Hold):

Total return is expected to closely approximate the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 2-STARS (Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 1-STAR (Strong Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares falling in price on an absolute basis.

Relevant benchmarks:

In North America, the relevant benchmark is the S&P 500 Index, in Europe and in Asia, the relevant benchmarks are the MSCI AC Europe Index and the MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, respectively.



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Disclosures

Stocks are ranked in accordance with the following ranking methodologies:

STARS Stock Reports:

Qualitative STARS rankings are determined and assigned by equity analysts. For reports containing STARS rankings refer to the Glossary section of the report for detailed methodology and the definition of STARS rankings.

Quantitative Stock Reports:

Quantitative rankings are determined by ranking a universe of common stocks based on 5 measures or model categories: Valuation, Quality, Growth, Street Sentiment, and Price Momentum. In the U.S., a sixth sub-category for Financial Health will also be displayed. Percentile scores are used to compare each company to all other companies in the same universe for each model category. The five [six] model category scores are then weighted and rolled up into a single percentile ranking for that company. For reports containing quantitative rankings refer to the Glossary section seof the report for detailed methodology and the definition of Quantitative rankings.

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STARS Stock Reports:

Global STARS Distribution as of September 30, 2023

Ranking	North America	Europe	Asia	Global
Buy	36.8%	34.5%	41.6%	37.4%
Hold	53.8%	51.2%	50.3%	52.6%
Sell	9.4%	14.3%	8.1%	10.1%
Total	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%

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